



PIRLS Reading Practice — Year 5

Providence English Private School

Set 3: The New Kid

Literary Text · 13 Questions · 40 Minutes

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

The New Kid

Daniel stood at the edge of the playground, watching groups of kids he didn't know laughing and chasing each other. It was his third new school in four years, ever since his mum's job started moving the family from city to city. He knew the routine by now: find somewhere quiet to stand, wait for the bell, try not to look as nervous as he felt.

"You're new," said a voice beside him. Daniel turned to see a boy about his age, holding a battered football under one arm. "I'm Theo. You want to play? We're one short for teams."

Daniel hesitated. In his experience, being the new kid usually meant being ignored, at least for the first week or two. "Sure," he said carefully, half-expecting Theo to change his mind.

Theo didn't. He waved Daniel over to a group of kids setting up jumpers as goalposts. "This is Daniel," Theo announced. "He's on my team."

The game was fast and a little chaotic, with rules that seemed to shift depending on who was arguing loudest. Daniel found himself running harder than he had in weeks, laughing when Theo attempted an ambitious shot that sailed wildly over the jumper-goal and into a hedge.

"Every single time," one of the other boys groaned, jogging off to retrieve it.

At break time, Theo dropped onto the bench beside Daniel without asking, as if they'd been friends for years rather than forty minutes. "So where'd you move from?" he asked, unwrapping a sandwich.

"Bristol, before that Manchester," Daniel said. "My mum's job keeps moving us around."

"That must be rubbish," Theo said, with surprising bluntness. "Always being the new one."

Daniel shrugged, though something in him relaxed slightly at having it acknowledged so plainly, instead of everyone pretending it was easy. "You get used to it. Sort of."

"Well, you're not new anymore," Theo said. "You're on the team now. That's basically the same as living here for years, as far as anyone's going to care."

Daniel almost laughed at how simple Theo made it sound, but there was something comforting in it too. Maybe it really could be that straightforward.

Over the next few weeks, Daniel noticed that Theo hadn't just included him in the football games. He'd introduced him to the librarian who let them read comics during wet lunchtimes, pointed out which teachers were strict about homework and which ones let things slide, and even saved him a seat on the coach for the school trip without being asked.

It wasn't that everything suddenly became effortless. Daniel still felt a flicker of the old nervousness on some mornings, still sometimes forgot which corridor led to the science block. But it was different now, having somewhere to sit at lunch that felt automatic rather than uncertain, having someone notice if he wasn't around.

Weeks later, when another new student arrived — a quiet girl who stood exactly where Daniel had stood on his first day — Daniel found himself walking over before he'd quite decided to.

"You're new," he said. "Want to play? We're one short for teams."

It was only as he said it that he realised he was repeating Theo's exact words, almost without meaning to. He glanced back at Theo, who grinned and gave him a small nod, as if to say: that's exactly how it's done.

Questions

1. MULTIPLE CHOICE · RETRIEVE

How many new schools has Daniel attended, including this one?

- ☐ One
- ☐ Two
- ☐ Three
- ☐ Four

2. MULTIPLE CHOICE · RETRIEVE

Why does Daniel's family move so often?

- ☐ His parents are divorced
- ☐ His mum's job moves the family from city to city
- ☐ They are visiting relatives
- ☐ Daniel keeps changing schools on purpose

3. WRITTEN RESPONSE · INFER

How does Daniel expect to be treated when he first arrives at the new school? Use evidence from the text.

4. MULTIPLE CHOICE · RETRIEVE

What does Theo do when he first meets Daniel?

- ☐ Ignores him completely
- ☐ Asks him to play football
- ☐ Warns him about the other kids
- ☐ Tells a teacher about him

5. WRITTEN RESPONSE · INTERPRET & INTEGRATE

Why do you think Daniel is surprised when Theo doesn't 'change his mind' about inviting him to play?

6. MULTIPLE CHOICE · INTERPRET & INTEGRATE

What does the phrase 'as if they'd been friends for years rather than forty minutes' suggest about Theo's behaviour?

- ☐ Theo is being fake and dishonest
- ☐ Theo is comfortable and relaxed with Daniel very quickly
- ☐ Theo has forgotten how long they've known each other
- ☐ Theo doesn't actually like Daniel

7. MULTIPLE CHOICE · RETRIEVE

Which detail shows that Theo helped Daniel settle in beyond just the football game?

- ☐ Theo taught Daniel to play football better
- ☐ Theo introduced him to the librarian and pointed out which teachers were strict
- ☐ Theo did Daniel's homework for him
- ☐ Theo moved to Daniel's house

8. WRITTEN RESPONSE · INTERPRET & INTEGRATE

Do you think Daniel still feels completely comfortable at his new school by the end of the story, or does he still have some worries? Support your answer with evidence.

9. MULTIPLE CHOICE · RETRIEVE

What is the new student in the final scene doing that mirrors Daniel's own first day?

- (A) Playing football alone
- (B) Standing exactly where Daniel stood on his first day
- (C) Crying at the edge of the playground
- (D) Talking to a teacher

10. MULTIPLE CHOICE · INTERPRET & INTEGRATE

Why is it significant that Daniel repeats Theo's exact words to the new girl?

- (A) It shows Daniel has forgotten his own name
- (B) It shows how much Theo's kindness has shaped Daniel's own behaviour
- (C) It shows Daniel is copying Theo to be funny
- (D) It shows Daniel doesn't know what else to say

11. WRITTEN RESPONSE · EVALUATE

What is the main message or lesson of this story? Explain your answer using details from the text.

12. MULTIPLE CHOICE · INTERPRET & INTEGRATE

What does Theo's nod at the very end of the story suggest?

- (A) He is annoyed that Daniel copied him
- (B) He silently approves of and recognises what Daniel just did
- (C) He wants to join the game himself
- (D) He is saying goodbye to Daniel

13. WRITTEN RESPONSE · EVALUATE

Imagine you were the new student in this story. Based on how Theo treated Daniel, how do you think you would feel after being invited to play? Explain your answer.

Answer Key & Model Answers

1. C — Three

The passage states this is his third new school in four years.

2. B — His mum's job moves the family from city to city

The text explicitly states his mum's job keeps moving them around.

3. *Written response*

Model answer: Daniel expects to be ignored, at least for the first week or two, since the passage says this is 'the routine' he knows and that being the new kid usually means being ignored.

Marking guidance: Full credit: identifies the expectation of being ignored, supported by textual evidence. Partial credit: describes his nervousness without the specific expectation.

4. B — Asks him to play football

Theo immediately invites Daniel to play football since they're one short for teams.

5. *Written response*

Model answer: Daniel is surprised because his past experience taught him that new-kid status usually leads to being ignored, so Theo's genuine, lasting friendliness goes against what Daniel has come to expect.

Marking guidance: Full credit: connects the surprise to his past experiences/expectations described earlier in the text. Partial credit: says he's surprised because Theo is nice, without connecting to his prior expectations.

6. B — Theo is comfortable and relaxed with Daniel very quickly

This phrase shows Theo's natural, easy friendliness, treating Daniel like a close friend right away.

7. B — Theo introduced him to the librarian and pointed out which teachers were strict

The passage lists several ways Theo helped Daniel adjust, including the librarian and information about teachers.

8. *Written response*

Model answer: Daniel feels much more settled but not completely worry-free — the text says he still feels 'a flicker of the old nervousness on some mornings' and sometimes forgets which corridor leads to the science block, even though he now has a stable place at lunch and a friend who notices him.

Marking guidance: Full credit: acknowledges the mixed feelings (better, but not perfect) with specific textual evidence. Partial credit: only says he feels better OR still worried, without the nuance or evidence.

9. B — Standing exactly where Daniel stood on his first day

The text directly states she is standing 'exactly where Daniel had stood on his first day.'

10. B — It shows how much Theo's kindness has shaped Daniel's own behaviour

This moment shows how Theo's earlier kindness has been passed on, with Daniel now doing for someone else what was once done for him.

11. *Written response*

Model answer: The story suggests that small acts of kindness — like including someone new — can have a lasting impact, and that this kindness can be passed on to others, as shown when Daniel repeats Theo's welcoming words to the new girl.

Marking guidance: Full credit: identifies a clear theme (kindness/inclusion matters and can be passed on) with supporting textual detail. Partial credit: identifies a vague or partial theme with little support.

12. B — He silently approves of and recognises what Daniel just did

The nod, described as 'that's exactly how it's done,' shows quiet approval and recognition.

13. *Written response*

Model answer: Answers will vary, but a thoughtful response might say the new student would likely feel relieved, welcomed, and less anxious, since being invited so directly and warmly removes much of the uncertainty of being new.

Marking guidance: Full credit: gives a plausible emotional response with reasoning connected to Theo's actions in the story. Partial credit: gives an emotion with little or no reasoning.